

Stay Safe Online – Prevention Checklist for College Students

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Course: CSE0001 – Digital Literacy | VIT Bhopal University

General Online Safety

1. **Use strong, unique passwords** for every account. Use a password manager if needed. Avoid using your name, birthdate, or roll number as a password.
 2. **Enable Two-Factor Authentication (2FA)** on all important accounts — email, social media, and banking apps. This adds an extra layer of protection even if your password is stolen.
 3. **Never click on suspicious links** sent via SMS, WhatsApp, or email — even if they appear to come from a known contact. Fraudsters often spoof phone numbers and email IDs.
 4. **Keep your phone and apps updated.** Software updates often contain critical security patches that protect against known vulnerabilities.
 5. **Avoid using public Wi-Fi** for banking, logging into accounts, or entering any personal information. Use a VPN if you must connect to public networks.
 6. **Do not install apps from unknown sources.** Only download apps from the official Google Play Store or Apple App Store. Never install apps at someone else's request over a call.
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UPI & Financial Safety (Specific Tips)

7. **COLLECT REQUEST = DEBIT, not credit.** If someone says they are "sending you money" and asks you to approve a UPI request, that is a scam. Entering your PIN on a collect request sends money OUT of your account, not into it.
 8. **Never share your UPI PIN, OTP, or ATM PIN with anyone** — not even with people claiming to be bank officials, customer care, or government representatives. Legitimate institutions never ask for this information.
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Reporting Cybercrime in India

- **National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal:** cybercrime.gov.in
- **National Cyber Crime Helpline:** 1930 (available 24x7)

- **For financial fraud:** Report immediately to your bank's helpline and file a complaint on the portal within the first hour to maximize chances of fund recovery.
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Remember: If something feels urgent, suspicious, or "too good to be true" online — pause, verify, and report.

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